

Employment Structure Proposal

Purpose

This proposal outlines a strategic restructuring of Elizabeth Lord's employment status to address the critical need for clear separation between Contender Development and Blackstream Christie's International Real Estate while maximizing the benefits for both companies.

The current shared services arrangement has raised potential public relations and legal concerns, as well as challenges in demonstrating the independent strength and stability of each organization. By transitioning Elizabeth from a full-time employee of these two companies to an independent contractor working separately for each company, we can effectively resolve these issues.

This new structure will not only create a distinct division between the two entities but also optimize costs, maintain consistent leadership in marketing and communications, and leverage Elizabeth's extensive 24 years of experience and expertise across both organizations.

The proposed solution offers flexibility, clear operational separation, and the opportunity for each company to benefit from high-level strategic marketing leadership tailored to their specific needs.

Proposal

Contender Development: Fractional Chief Marketing Officer (CMO)

- 1099 Independent Contractor (minimum guarantee of 10 hours/week*50 weeks)
- Focus: Strategic marketing leadership, PR, and communications

Blackstream Christie's International Real Estate: Fractional CMO

- 1099 Independent Contractor (minimum guarantee of 10 hours/week*50 weeks)
- Focus: Branding, marketing strategy, remote office marketing, and agent relations

Cost Breakdown

Contender Development: Fractional Chief Marketing Officer

- Hourly rate: \$100/hour (Typical hourly rate is \$200 - \$350 | \$135 for MD)
- Guaranteed weekly hours: 10
- Annual cost: **\$50,000** (10 hrs/wk * 50 weeks * \$100/hr)

Blackstream Christie's International Real Estate: Fractional Chief Marketing Officer

- Hourly rate: \$100/hour
- Guaranteed weekly hours: 10
- Annual cost: **\$50,000** (10 hrs/wk * 50 weeks * \$100/hr)

Benefits for Both Companies

The proposed fractional employment structure offers significant benefits to both Contender and Blackstream compared to the existing arrangement.

Cost Efficiency

- Each company commits to only 10 hours per week at \$100/hour, totaling \$50,000 annually per company.
- This arrangement is more cost-effective than the previous \$100,000 salary split, especially considering the flexibility it provides.

Flexibility

- Companies can utilize Elizabeth's services beyond the minimum 10 hours as needed for additional projects.
- This allows for scalability without the commitment of a full-time employee.

Clear Separation

- The fractional structure creates a distinct line between Contender and Blackstream, addressing previous concerns about company division.

Access to Expertise

- Both companies retain access to Elizabeth's 24 years of experience in marketing, branding, web development, PR, and brand strategy.

Resource Optimization

- Neither company over-commits resources, as they pay only for the hours used.
- This allows for better budget allocation and resource management.

Specific Benefits for Contender

- Access to CMO-level strategy without the overhead of a full-time executive.
- A senior level female on your leadership team to show diversity as well as an impressive history of working on high profile projects.
- Ability to scale marketing efforts up or down based on project needs.
- Retention of Elizabeth's institutional knowledge in a more flexible format.

Specific Benefits for Blackstream

- Dedicated strategic marketing leadership without full-time costs.
- Ability to show career growth to potential candidates.
- Consistent and continued development of programs and initiatives where there is no disruption in the perception of strength as Blackstream pivots.
- Flexibility to adjust marketing focus across Blackstream and its subsidiaries.
- Continued leadership of existing staff on projects, strategy, and mentoring.

This new structure addresses the need for separation between the companies while providing both with access to high-level marketing expertise. It offers a more adaptable and cost-effective solution compared to the previous salary-split arrangement, allowing each company to maximize the value of Elizabeth's contributions within their specific needs and budget constraints.